



WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Trump said he would hit** China with a 100% additional tariff and impose new export controls on critical software products after Beijing placed restrictions on the export of rare-earth minerals, hours after his threats of retaliation sent the S&P 500 to its worst day since April. **A1, A8**
- ◆ **The stock decline** was steep enough to wipe out weekly gains by the S&P 500 and the Nasdaq. The Dow, S&P 500 and the Nasdaq fell 1.9%, 2.7% and 3.6%, respectively. **B11**
- ◆ **Johnson & Johnson** is in talks to buy Protagonist Therapeutics in a deal that would solidify the companies' existing partnership, according to people familiar with the matter. **B9**
- ◆ **German-chemical company** BASF agreed to sell a majority stake in its auto-coatings business to Carlyle Group for about \$6.71 billion. **B9**
- ◆ **VW's vehicle deliveries** rose slightly in the third quarter despite big declines in China and North America. **B9**
- ◆ **Jeep maker Stellantis's** vehicle shipments rose by 13%, driven by strong growth in North America on the back of inventory improvements. **B9**
- ◆ **IPOs made a comeback** in the third quarter fueled by short-term clarity about tariffs and interest rates, a new EY report said. **B11**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The White House** said it was conducting mass layoffs of federal employees in response to the shutdown, an unprecedented step that follows through on weeks of threats meant to increase pressure on Democrats. **A1**
- ◆ **The deployment** of American troops to Israel this weekend is just the start of an extraordinarily complex effort to secure the fragile peace in Gaza and establish a framework to govern the enclave. **A1, A6**
- ◆ **Venezuelan opposition** leader María Corina Machado was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize for her crusade to fight the country's dictatorship. **A1**
- ◆ **MIT became** the first university to reject a sweeping proposal from the Trump administration offering funding advantages in exchange for far-reaching campus changes. **A3**
- ◆ **AstraZeneca is the latest** major drugmaker to strike a deal with the Trump administration on lowering prices of its drugs, some of which will be available to buy through a government website. **A2**
- ◆ **Peru's Congress ousted** President Dina Boluarte from power in the latest round of political turmoil. **A6**
- ◆ **Russia launched** a barrage targeting energy infrastructure in Ukraine, causing blackouts in the capital and killing at least one civilian. **A7**

NOONAN

Trump's big beautiful Gaza peace plan **A13**

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Trump to Impose New China Levy

President retaliates against rare-earth restrictions, threatens to cancel Xi meeting

President Trump said he would hit China with a 100%

By Gavin Bade, Lingling Wei and Brian Schwartz

additional tariff and impose new export controls on critical software products after Beijing

placed restrictions on the export of rare-earth minerals, hours after his threats of retaliation sent the S&P 500 to its worst day since April.

The new measures would take effect Nov. 1, Trump said in a Truth Social post. The export controls would affect “any and all critical software,” he wrote. The measures could take effect even sooner, he said, “depending on any further actions or changes taken by China.”

“It is impossible to believe that China would have taken such an action, but they have,

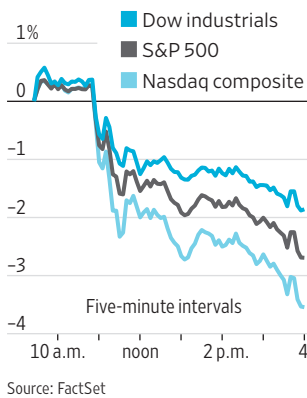
and the rest is History,” Trump wrote.

After months of trade talks with China, U.S. officials were cautiously optimistic the two sides had made progress. But China's announcement about the new controls Thursday elicited shock and anger within the White House.

Some members of the administration

◆ **Qualcomm is in crosshairs** of trade fight..... **A8**
◆ **Weekly gains for stocks** are wiped out..... **B11**

Index performance on Friday



Deadly Blast Levels Tennessee Explosives Plant



DEVASTATION: Debris litters the ground Friday after a powerful explosion at a defense contractor about 60 miles west of Nashville. Authorities said there were fatalities in the explosion at Accurate Energetic Systems and 19 people were missing. **A4**

Israel Says Cease-Fire Began in Gaza As Questions Loom Over Its Future

Israel declared the start of a cease-fire in Gaza on Friday, the first step in a truce-for-hostages deal that will see a small contingent of U.S. support troops deployed to the region as part of an extraordinarily complex effort to keep the peace and establish a framework to govern the enclave.

Israeli troops withdrew on

By Michael R. Gordon, Summer Said and Omar Abdel-Baqi

Friday morning from parts of the Gaza Strip as part of the cease-fire deal, Israeli and Arab officials said. The cease-fire started a 72-hour window for release of the remaining

hostages in Gaza and allows for an influx of humanitarian aid into the territory.

Nearly 200 U.S. troops who report to Adm. Brad Cooper of the U.S. Central Command are scheduled to arrive in Israel by Sunday to establish a coordination center that will monitor the cease-fire and organize the flow of humanitarian

aid, logistics and security assistance to Gaza.

There are no plans for the U.S. troops, who include planners, transportation and engineering experts and security experts, to set foot in

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◆ **Israelis, Gazans allow** themselves to hope..... **A6**

White House Starts Federal Layoffs

WASHINGTON—The White House said Friday that it began conducting mass layoffs of federal employees in response to the government shutdown, an unprecedented step that follows through on weeks of threats meant to increase pressure on Democrats.

By Natalie Andrews, Ken Thomas and Annie Linskey

“The RIFs have begun,” White House Office of Management and Budget Director Russell Vought posted on X, using an abbreviation for reductions in force. An OMB official characterized the retrenchment as “substantial,” and a White House official said it would affect “thousands of federal workers.”

“It will be a lot and it will be Democrat-oriented,” Trump said in the Oval Office. “They started this thing.”

More than 4,000 employees at agencies across the federal government were issued layoff notices, according to a filing late Friday by the administration in a San Francisco federal court. Layoffs hit the Departments of Health and Human Services, Energy, Homeland Security, Education, Treasury, Commerce, and Housing and Urban Development.

The move marks a major escalation in Trump's efforts to force a resolution to the partisan standoff on Capitol Hill and tests the limits of his executive power to trim the federal workforce. Congress has been at a standstill since the shutdown started Oct. 1, and many federal workers and military servicemembers are set to miss their first full paychecks this coming week.

More than 1,100 workers at HHS across several divisions received reduction-in-force notices on Friday. Some of the people who lost their jobs were deemed “at odds with the Trump administration's Make America Healthy Again agenda,” said Andrew Nixon, a spokesman for the department.

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◆ **Emboldened Trump is** pushing harder..... **A4**

Venezuelan Opposition Leader Awarded the Nobel Peace Prize

Venezuelan opposition leader María Corina Machado, a pro-democracy activist who has been in hiding for most of the past year, was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize for her long crusade to fight dictatorship in the country.

By Gareth Vipers, Juan Forero and Kejal Vyas

Machado, 58 years old, is in some ways an unusual choice for the Nobel committee: She

is conservative, and cites Margaret Thatcher as an inspiration. She is known for her pugnacious approach to fighting the regime. And she has been close to the Trump administration and Republican

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President Orders Harshest Conditions For Spared Convicts

Officials say prisons are too good for 37 murderers saved from death penalty

By Jess Bravin

Among the last actions by former President Joe Biden before leaving the Oval Office was commuting the death sentences of 37 convicted murderers.

Hours after President Trump took over, he ordered the life sentences of these men be made, in effect, a living hell.

With that guidance, officials canceled plans to transfer most of the inmates to mainline prisons. Instead, Emil Bove III, the acting deputy attorney general at the time, ordered all but a handful requiring specialized medical treatment be housed in the U.S. Peniten-

tiary at Florence, Colo., the harshest institution in the federal system.

Inmates at the Colorado prison—intended for the nation's most violent—typically spend 23 hours a day alone in their cells. At a meeting in May with Attorney General Pam Bondi for families of loved ones killed by the 37 convicts, some officials said they wished conditions at the prison, known as ADX, were even worse.

Aaron Reitz, then an assistant attorney general, led a roundtable with the families and said he was disappointed that the cells “have windows to see daylight.” He suggested that prison

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Another Controversial Stance From RFK Jr.: Jeans at the Gym

Health secretary's workout habit is a source of curiosity and bewilderment

By Liz Essley Whyte

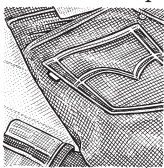
When Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. is spotted working out, it's not his “Make America Healthy Again” agenda that gets the gym talking. It's his jeans. The cabinet member, who

at age 71 can still leg press 700 pounds, regularly works out in denim.

He wore just jeans—no shirt—in a video filmed during his presidential campaign.

He wore jeans alongside Defense Secretary Pete Heg-

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True blue

EXCHANGE



CRUSHED California's wine industry has too many grapes and not enough drinkers. **B1**